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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Meta Platforms** is ending fact-checking and removing restrictions on speech on Facebook and Instagram, Zuckerberg said, in what he described as an attempt to restore free expression on the platforms. **A1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** fell amid fears inflation could remain stubbornly high this year. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow retreated 1.1%, 1.9% and 0.4%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **The share of workers** who quit their job in November fell from a month earlier, a sign of weakening in the labor market. **A3**

◆ **Cintas, a maker of** workplace products, made public a \$5.1 billion offer for uniform supplier UniFirst, whose board had repeatedly rebuffed an overture. **B1**

◆ **The Justice Department** added six apartment landlords to its lawsuit against RealPage, expanding the scope of its allegations that the company's rent-setting algorithm enabled illegal price fixing. **B1**

◆ **Amazon.com plans** to spend at least \$11 billion to expand its cloud and artificial-intelligence infrastructure in Georgia to meet a boom in demand. **B4**

◆ **Getty Images and Shutterstock** agreed to merge into one visual-content company with an enterprise value of about \$3.7 billion. **B3**

◆ **Payroll-services** company Paychex will acquire rival Paycor HCM in a transaction with an enterprise value of about \$4.1 billion. **B3**

◆ **Unionized dockworkers** and employers returned to negotiations, with both sides still divided over the issue of automation at the ports. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **President-elect Trump** declined to rule out using military or economic coercion to gain control of Greenland and the Panama Canal, ratcheting up his campaign to expand America's global footprint. **A1**

◆ **The Biden administration** is negotiating with the Taliban to exchange Americans detained in Afghanistan for at least one high-profile prisoner alleged to be an Osama bin Laden associate held in Guantanamo Bay. **A1**

◆ **A judge barred** the Justice Department from releasing special counsel Jack Smith's report on his investigation of Trump, while an appeals judge denied Trump's separate bid to delay his criminal sentencing in a hush-money case. **A4**

◆ **The Republican-led** House passed a bill with bipartisan support that would impose harsher penalties on some people who are in the country illegally. **A3**

◆ **A wildfire prompted** officials to order residents in a western Los Angeles neighborhood to evacuate their homes as forecasters warned a potentially life-threatening windstorm could fuel its rapid spread. **A3**

◆ **The U.S. declared** that a paramilitary group fighting Sudan's government committed genocide in a bloody civil war that U.S. officials have called the world's worst humanitarian catastrophe. **A16**

◆ **Died: Jean-Marie Le Pen**, 96, co-founder of France's far-right National Front. **A7** ... **Peter Yarrow**, 86, folk musician with the trio Peter, Paul and Mary. **A2**

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Meta to Get Rid of Fact-Checking

Facebook, Instagram speech restrictions are removed as CEO works on Trump ties

By MEGHAN BOBROWSKY
AND GARETH VIPERS

Mark Zuckerberg built up Facebook's content-policing efforts in the wake of Donald Trump's first presidential election. Now the Meta Platforms chief executive is reversing course as he embraces a second Trump presidency.

Meta is ending fact-checking and removing restrictions on

speech across Facebook and Instagram, Zuckerberg said in a video Tuesday, a move he described as an attempt to restore free expression on its platforms.

"We're going to get back to our roots and focus on reducing mistakes, simplifying our policies and restoring free expression on our platforms," Zuckerberg said in the video. He said Meta is getting rid of fact-checkers and, starting in the U.S., replacing them with a so-called Community Notes system similar to Elon Musk's on the X platform, in which users flag posts they think need more context.

While Meta will continue to

target illegal behavior, Zuckerberg wrote in a Threads post, it will stop enforcing content rules about immigration and gender that are "out of touch with mainstream discourse."

Zuckerberg's plan is likely to reshape the experience of billions of people who use Meta's platforms. It steers sharply away from efforts started years ago in response to complaints from users, advertisers and politicians that abusive and deceptive content had run amok on Meta's apps. The effort to rein in such speech sparked its own backlash from people—especially conservatives—who said it often strayed into censorship.

The pivot comes as Zuckerberg looks to align himself and his company with the incoming Trump administration. The Meta CEO has had a sometimes strained relationship with Trump, which descended into open acrimony after Meta suspended Trump's accounts in the wake of the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the U.S. Capitol by Trump supporters. This summer, Trump suggested Zuckerberg might be imprisoned if he perceived Meta to be disrupting the election.

But Zuckerberg has been working to regain good relations with the right. In August, *Please turn to page A2*

Trump Escalates Panama, Greenland Threats

President-elect puts military or economic coercion on the table as he upends norms

PALM BEACH, Fla.—President-elect Donald Trump declined to rule out using military or economic coercion to gain control of Greenland and the Panama Canal, ratcheting up his campaign to expand the U.S.'s global footprint.

By Alex Leary,
Tarini Parti
and Vivian Salama

"I'm not going to commit to that now. It might be that you'll have to do something," Trump said at a news conference Tuesday. He was responding to a question about whether he could offer reassurances that he wouldn't leverage U.S. military and economic might to get his way.

Since winning the election, Trump has repeatedly raised the idea of taking over the Panama Canal from Panama and taking control of Greenland from Denmark. He has also said that Canada should become the 51st U.S. state, in an apparent effort to troll Justin Trudeau, the country's departing prime minister.

During Tuesday's news conference, Trump threatened to hit Denmark with tariffs "at a very high level" if Danish officials don't cooperate with his *Please turn to page A4*

◆ **Canadian populist taps** into discontent..... **A16**

Powerful Earthquake Leaves Scores Dead in Tibet



ON A MISSION: Emergency crews work at a village in Changsuo township Tuesday after a quake struck near the holy city of Shigatse in China's Tibet region, killing at least 126 people. Scan the code on A16 for a video of damage and rescue efforts.

How to Fix Boeing: A Repair Manual

Aerospace leaders suggest ways the jet maker can pull out of its tailspin

By SHARON TERLEP
AND ANDREW TANGEL

A fuselage panel that blew off in midair. Mishaps on the factory floor. Stranded astronauts. A crippling strike. Five straight annual losses.

Boeing's travails keep piling up, and that list doesn't include a pair of fatal accidents in 2018 and 2019 that killed 346 people. The 108-year-old jet maker this summer agreed to plead guilty in a federal criminal case related to those crashes. The string of crises has left the

company bleeding cash, mired in manufacturing problems and at odds with airlines, regulators and its own employees. On Dec. 29, 179 people were killed in a South Korean crash whose cause is now under investigation.

"We're at a low here, folks," Boeing's new CEO, Kelly Ortberg, told the company's employees in a November all-hands meeting.

There's a lot riding on Boeing's ability to pull out of its nose dive. Boeing is the biggest U.S. exporter and one of *Please turn to page A8*

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Researchers want to know why some ultra-processed foods are riskier than others. **A9**

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Anthropic is in talks to raise \$2 billion in a deal valuing the AI startup at \$60 billion. **B1**

U.S. Weighs Swap With Taliban to Free American Hostages

By ALEXANDER WARD
AND BRETT FORREST

WASHINGTON—The Biden administration is negotiating with the Taliban to exchange U.S. citizens detained in Afghanistan for at least one high-profile prisoner alleged to be an Osama bin Laden associate held in Guantanamo Bay.

The Biden administration, which has been discussing a deal with the Taliban since at least July, told the group on Nov. 14 that the U.S. would release Muhammad Rahim al Afghani, who the U.S. government alleges was a senior al

Qaeda aide, if the Afghan rulers released George Glezmman, Ryan Corbett and Mahmoud Habibi, U.S. citizens seized in Afghanistan in 2022.

The Taliban counteroffered that day, seeking Rahim and two others in exchange for Glezmman and Corbett. The Taliban deny holding Habibi.

President Biden had yet to decide on the proposal, national security adviser Jake Sullivan told House Foreign Affairs Committee members in a Dec. 17 classified session, attendees said in interviews with The Wall Street Journal. *Please turn to page A6*

The Toughest Challenge In Sports

New franchises agonize over finding a name

By KATIE DEIGHTON

North Carolinians supporting Gastonia's baseball team had a confusing summer. One day they were cheering for the Gastonia Bologna. A few weeks later they watched the Galactic Dinosaurs take the field. Then they were there for the Garden Gnomes.

Altogether, the new entry into the Atlantic League of Professional Baseball tried out eight different monikers over the 2024 season. The team was experiencing a highly managed identity crisis.

"We didn't want to rush the final name," said Lauren *Please turn to page A8*

Firms Struggle to Find Workspaces They Like

By PETER GRANT

The troubled U.S. office industry is starting the new year with a problem it hasn't contended with in years: Some business districts face a looming shortage of top-shelf workspace.

Office vacancy overall remains near record levels in many cities, where a glut of unwanted and aging workspace is keeping a lid on rents and depressing office values. Decades of overbuilding made the U.S. office market vulnerable when the pandemic hit and remote work flourished.

More recently, big firms in technology, finance, transportation and entertainment are telling their employees they need to be in the office more often, in some cases five days a week.

These large tenants tend to want the same thing—buildings offering plenty of out-

door space, upscale fitness centers and restaurants, and locations near transport hubs. They are increasingly finding slim pickings, especially for hot spots such as New York City's Park Avenue, Miami's Brickell district and Century City in Los Angeles.

Yet even some tenants in cities that have been hit hardest by the glut of space, such as Washington, D.C., and Chicago, are shocked by the few choices on the top shelf.

"Brokers kept coming to us, and I was like: That's it? Is that the best you got?" said Ira Coleman, chairman of McDermott Will & Emery, referring to the law firm's recent search for space in Washington, D.C.

Now, the country's largest office owners are moving to fill that void. After years when most developers wouldn't *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Property Report**..... **B6**

Agentforce
can help
millions of flyers
navigate
travel hiccups.
Every hour.

Agentforce What AI Was Meant to Be